Starter

Starter: Fun times!

Lesson 0-1
Book pages 10-12

💡 **Big idea:** We start the year by talking about **free time** and **holidays**. We read short blog posts about a great day, we revise **articles** (a, an, the), the **past simple**, and **comparative and superlative** adjectives, and we write about **our best moment**.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Read short blog posts and match them with photos
- Talk about my summer holiday
- Revise articles, past simple and comparatives
- Write a paragraph about my best moment

📖 Key words

free time وقت الفراغ	**blog post** تدوينة	**celebrate** يحتفل	**experience** تجربة
countryside الريف	**perfect** مثالي	**advert** إعلان	**organiser** منظِّم
nervous متوتر	**successful** ناجح		

Topics from the posts

- Science of the future: Dana visited a modern museum and saw a robot working
- Our new pet: Ryan got a kitten from his grandparents
- By the sea: Hashim spent his birthday with friends at the beach
- A new city: Nancy's school trip to Paris

Articles

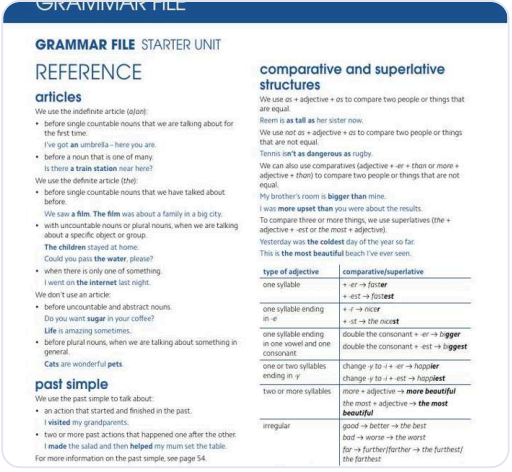
- **a / an** = the first time we talk about a single countable noun: I've got **an** umbrella.
- **the** = something we talked about before or only one: I saw a film. **The** film was great.
- **No article** with uncountable and plural nouns in general: Life is amazing. Cats are wonderful pets.

Past simple

- For finished actions in the past: I **visited** my grandparents.
- Regular verbs add **-ed**: play → played
- Irregular verbs: go → **went**, see → **saw**, eat → **ate** (see the Irregular verbs table, p.49)

Comparatives and superlatives

- One syllable: fast → fast**er** → the fast**est**
- Ending in -y: happy → happ**ier** → the happ**iest**
- Two or more syllables: **more** beautiful → **the most** beautiful
- Irregular: good → better → the best, bad → worse → the worst
- as + adjective + as: Reem is **as tall as** her sister.



GRAMMAR FILE STARTER UNIT

REFERENCE

articles

We use the indefinite article (*a*/*an*):

- before single countable nouns that we are talking about for the first time.
  I've got **an** umbrella – here you are.
- before a noun that is one of many.
  Is there **a train station** near here?

We use the definite article (*the*):

- before single countable nouns that we have talked about before.
  We saw **a film**. **The film** was about a family in a big city.
- with uncountable nouns or plural nouns, when we are talking about a specific object or group.
  The children stayed at home.
  Could you pass **the water**, please?
- when there is only one of something.
  I went on **the internet** last night.

We don't use an article:

- before uncountable and abstract nouns.
  Do you want **sugar** in your coffee?
  Life is amazing sometimes.
- before plural nouns, when we are talking about something in general.
  Cats are wonderful **pets**.

past simple

We use the past simple to talk about:

- an action that started and finished in the past.
  I **visited** my grandparents.
- two or more past actions that happened one after the other.
  I **made** the salad and then **helped** my mum set the table.

For more information on the past simple, see page 54.

comparative and superlative structures

We use *as* + adjective + *as* to compare two people or things that are equal.
Reem is **as tall as** her sister now.

We use *not as* + adjective + *as* to compare two people or things that are not equal.
Tennis isn't **as dangerous as** rugby.

We can also use comparatives (adjective + *-er* + *than* or *more* + adjective + *than*) to compare two people or things that are not equal.
My brother's room is **bigger than** mine.
I was **more upset than** you were about the results.

To compare three or more things, we use superlatives (*the* + adjective + *-est* or *the most* + adjective).
Yesterday was **the coldest** day of the year so far.
This is **the most beautiful** beach I've ever seen.

type of adjective	comparative/superlative
one syllable	+ *-er* → *faster* + *-est* → *fastest*
one syllable ending in *-e*	+ *-r* → *nicer* + *-st* → *the nicest*
one syllable ending in one vowel and one consonant	double the consonant + *-er* → *bigger* double the consonant + *-est* → *biggest*
one or two syllables ending in *y*	change *-y* to *-i* + *-er* → *happier* change *-y* to *-i* + *-est* → *happiest*
two or more syllables	*more* + adjective → ***more beautiful*** *the most* + adjective → ***the most beautiful***
irregular	*good* → *better* → *the best* *bad* → *worse* → *the worst* *far* → *further/farther* → *the furthest/the farthest*

Grammar file: articles, past simple and comparatives

✏️ Examples

Complete: I've got ___ new video game at home.

Answer: a

Make a superlative: Yesterday was ___ (cold) day of the year.

Answer: the coldest

⭐ Remember

- Before you write about your best moment, answer: When? What did you do? What skills did you use? Why was it the best?
- Use the past simple for a story about the past.

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ She is more tall than me. ✓ She is taller than me.
- ✗ I goed to the beach. ✓ I went to the beach.
- ✗ The life is amazing. ✓ Life is amazing.

🧩 **Activity:** Write four sentences about your last holiday: two true and two false. Your partner guesses the false ones

✅ Check yourself

1. Past simple of see?
2. Superlative of good?
3. Which article: ___ Moon?

Answers: (1) saw ، (2) the best ، (3) the